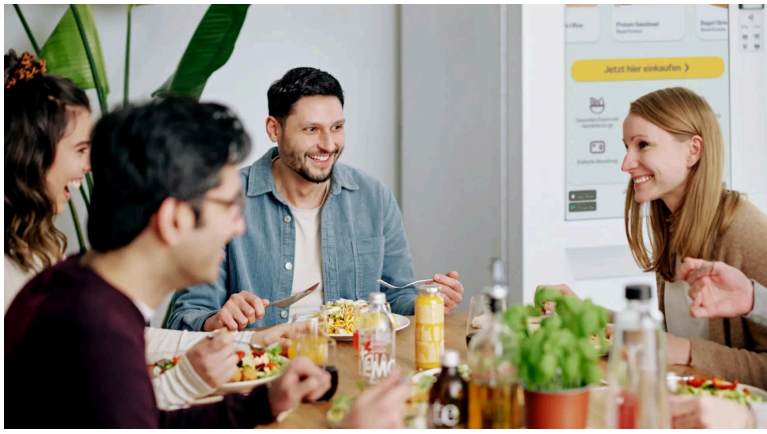
About Foodji

Foodji is a Munich-based food technology company founded in 2016 by Felix Munte, Daniel von Canal, and their partners. It operates as a provider of intelligent food vending machines that offer fresh, healthy, and high-quality meals around the clock.



$28.3 million

have been raised in funding to expand Foodji's technological lead and geographic footprint, solidifying its position as a market leader in Germany for ultra-fresh, autonomous catering.

Company Values

The organisation is built on four pillars ensuring that high-quality nutrition is not a privilege but a standard accessible to all employee groups.

- **Energetically**
- **Innovative**
- **Caring**
- **Optimistic**

Mission

Foodji's mission is to make fresh, nutritious food available exactly where people spend their daily lives - strengthening minds, bodies, and communities.

Vision

Foodji aims to provide over 10 million workers with access to healthy food while simultaneously working toward a "Zero Food Waste" future.

Services and Offerings

Product Range

Foodji provides a rotating catalogue of over 300 main courses, snacks and drinks, with roughly 50% being vegetarian or vegan.

Smart Vending Machine

Foodji's machines feature their proprietary algorithm to analyse specific demand behaviour and their app allows users to reserve meals in advances and pay contactlessly.

Digitalised Subsidies

Foodji's platform integrates tax-free meal allowances directly into the app, reducing administrative burdens for employers while increasing employee purchasing power.

Full-Service Management

Foodji handles all operational tasks, including installation, re-stocking machines 2-3 times per week, cleaning and technical maintenance.

Problems Being Solved

Foodji addresses several critical gaps in traditional corporate catering:

The "Catering Gap"

Approximately 90% of SMEs cannot afford a traditional canteen. Foodji provides a low-cost, space-saving alternative that requires only 1m^2 of space.

24/7 Availability

Unlike traditional canteens with limited hours, Foodji serves shift and night workers who often lack healthy options during non-traditional times.

Food Waste

The industry average for food waste is very high; Foodji uses proprietary AI to reduce this waste by 70% through precision demand forecasting.

Allignment with SDGs Goals

Foodji has embedded the UN Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs) into the core of all their operational areas and supply chain, treating sustainability as a cost-saving and product-development strategy rather than just a slogan.



AI Planning

Foodji tackles SDG 12 by using proprietary AI to match food production with exact consumer demand at each location. This precision forecasting allows the company to reduce retail food waste by 70% compared to traditional catering averages. By aligning supply with real-time app data, they prevent surplus from entering the waste stream.



Partners

Foodji targets the SDG 14 and 15 by collaborating with carefully selected regional and sustainable partners that promote vegetarian and vegan alternatives. Their partners include BettaF!sh, Plantes and Lemonaid, reducing transportation routes, CO2 emissions and impact on the environment whilst supporting regional economies and communities.



Packaging

Beyond its AI-driven food waste reduction, Foodji re-addresses SDG 12 through its commitment to recyclable disposable packaging for simple and effective waste separation for its meal containers, ensuring that packaging can be easily reintroduced into the recycling stream rather than ending up in landfills. Foodji actively evaluates its materials to drive sustainable improvements and explores future interventions.



Delivery route & filling

Foodji advances SDG 9 by relying on manufacturies producing in Germnay and sourcing the resources and ingredients regionaly. Additionally, the distance between individual locations is around 9km, ensuring short transportation routes, which they're are aiming to further reduce as Foodji continues to expand.



Foodsharing

Foodji supports SDG 3 and 10 by providing a rotating menu of over 300 nutrient-dense, fresh dishes and donating the surplus meals to schemes in Berlin. By making healthy, fresh meals Foodji empowers everyone to maintain healthy diets.

Germany Landscape

Foodji operates within a high-compliance German landscape where aggressive environmental directives and a shift toward circular economy mandate a strategic integration of operational efficiency and social equity.

Politically: Germany has shifted toward high-compliance sustainability, driven by a mix of a conservative-led government and aggressive EU-wide environmental directives. The current and upcoming regulatory environment includes:

Regulation	Core Requirement
Waste Framework Directive	By 2030, Germany must reduce food waste by 30% per capita at the retail and consumption levels (including vending and food services)
VerpackDG (DE)	Companies using single-use packaging must pay into a central fund to support reusable infrastructure.
PPWR (EU)	100% recyclability for all packaging; 10% reuse quota for takeaway meals.
EWKFondsG (DE)	Single-use plastic tax to fund public waste cleanup.

Socially: Germany is navigating a "Pragmatic Sustainability" phase. While the majority of Germans still strive for eco-friendly lives, as evidenced by the record participation in the national water bottle deposit scheme, climateflation has forced a shift toward values like convenience, health, local resilience and radical transparency. There is a growing social demand for catering parity, where the everyone has the same access to high-quality nutrition.

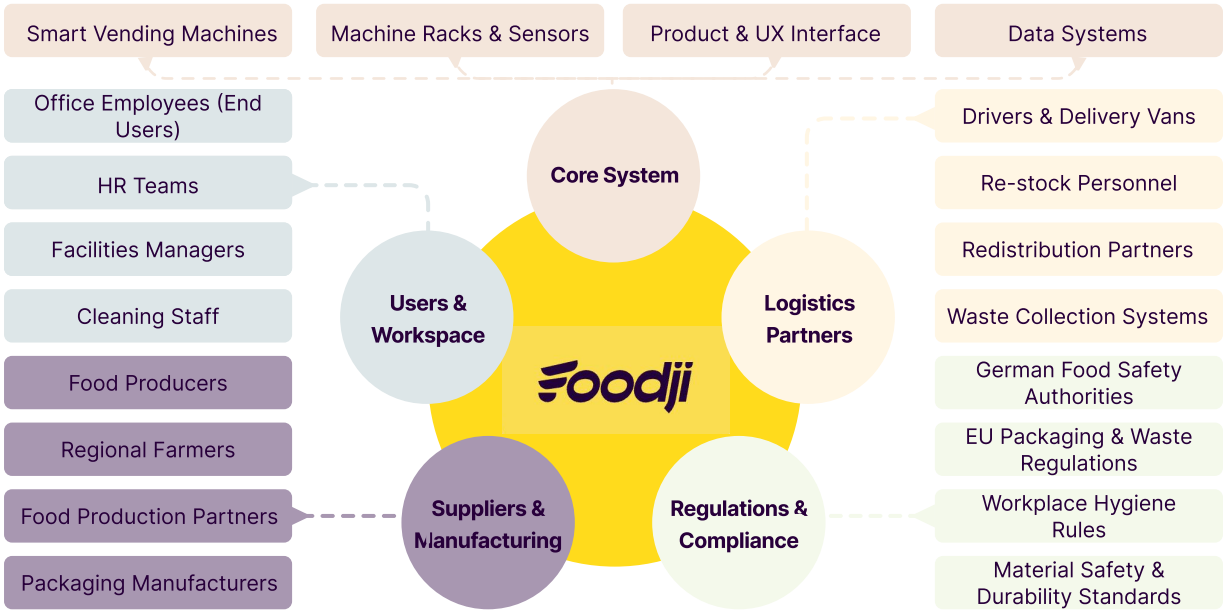
Strategic Approach

In light of Germany's shift towards high compliance sustainability and the implementation of new, stricter mandates, Foodji's primary strategic opportunity lies in SDG 12: Responsible Consumption and Production. While the company leads in food waste reduction through demand forecasting, it is imperative that they transition to a closed-loop packaging ecosystem.



Ecosystem Mapping

To further understand the ecosystem, the interconnected network of technical, social and regulatory stakeholders that sustain Foodji's current operations and that would need to be mobilised to improve the packaging lifecycle were mapped out.



Theory of Change

Building on the ecosystem analysis, the Theory of Change were developed to identify the causal links required to align Foodji with SDG 12, focusing on interventions that address current recycling bottlenecks.

IMPACT GOAL: By December 2028, Foodji will transition to a closed-loop ecosystem for its high-density locations, achieving a 65% net reduction in packaging-related carbon emissions and a 95% material recovery rate, while ensuring operational costs remain within 15% of current benchmarks.

PREREQUISITES

- Existing waste recycling bins co-located near Foodji fridges to make disposal convenient.
- Agreements with waste contractors to ensure the material is properly recovered and recycled.
- Users already use the Foodji app for purchases.
- Clear and specific disposal guidelines are finalised.
- App must feature a secure, real-time scanning module capable of verifying geolocation to ensure items are disposed of at legitimate points.
- Implementation of unique identification to prevent fraud such as multiple scans of the same item.
- Include loyalty platform on app to manage point accrual, validate genuine redemptions, and integrate with the fridge's payment system for rewards.

INPUTS

- Packaging and bin adaptations, that include clear bar codes or scanning ability for correct recording of appropriate disposal.
- Scanning module and real-time point tracking in the app.
- Clear user interface in app explaining the point system.
- Clear user-facing signage and behaviour cues placed near machines.
- Budgeted reward redemptions and app maintenance.
- Agreement with office facility managers to place dedicated bins.

ACTIVITIES

- Installing instructions on the machine and disposal bins.
- Launching new feature to all users in the target location.
- Users scan the packaging and appropriate bin during disposal.
- App triggers celebratory sounds/visuals and updates points immediately after correct disposal.
- Launching office-wide leaderboards or team challenges to increase behavioural change.

ASSUMPTIONS

- Users will scan & dispose of packaging correctly (not just scan and bin it anywhere).
- Points/prizes are attractive enough to motivate extra step.
- Barcodes remain scannable despite being handled.
- Return points and sorting bins are located as conveniently.
- Bins are emptied and maintained regularly.
- User has consistent access to smartphones, data connections, and digital literacy to use the scanning feature.
- High-quality recycling infrastructure exists in the local region to actually process the materials after collection.

OUTPUTS

- Increased use of the recycling system to scan waste, leading to higher amount of packaging being recycled properly
- Quantity of points converted into food rewards (such as discounted items or free meals)
- Number of vouchers successfully spent at Foodji kiosks.

STAKEHOLDERS

- Shift workers and office staff
- Office Managers
- Waste Contractors
- Packaging Manufacturers
- App Design Team

INTENDED CONSEQUENCES

Short Term:

- Moves recycling from a forgotten task to a rewarding experience.
- Rewards for correct sorting lead to less "contaminated" recycling

Mid Term:

- Repetitive scanning turns proper disposal into an automatic behaviour.
- Fewer contaminated bins lower the overall disposal fees for the client facility.

UNINTENDED CONSEQUENCES

- Users might attempt to scan the same barcode multiple times or scan discarded items found in regular bins to gain more points.
- If the rewards are removed, users may stop recycling altogether because the "intrinsic" value wasn't fostered.

Intervention Proposal

Intervention 1: Glass Jars

The first intervention involves the replacement of Foodji's current HALOPACK packaging with glass jars in high-density locations. Unlike disposable packaging, this intervention creates a closed-loop system where containers are collected, professionally cleaned, and reused before recycling. While this introduces significant operational complexity and requires substantial upfront investment, it strengthens Foodji's commitment to sustainability.

This intervention directly targets the 65% packaging waste reduction goal, by eliminating single-use packaging for Foodji's meals, extending the packaging lifespan, and creating infrastructure for future

circular initiatives. By focusing on high-density locations, the intervention ensures that collection and reverse logistics remain viable.

The intervention's success is evaluated through both quantitative and qualitative metrics. The primary quantitative performance indicator is the annual reduction in tonnes of HALOPACK avoided. To ensure financial viability, the operational cost per meal can be calculated, alongside the jar return rate to determine the system's circular efficiency. Qualitative metrics include customers' brand perception and feedback.

The system scales by expanding to new vending locations within range of established cleaning facilities. It is adaptable to diverse client environments, or can use different container sizes to accommodate a shifting product range.

Intervention 2: Gamifying Disposal

This intervention suggests transforming packaging disposal from passive waste disposal into an engaging and rewarding behaviour. Through Foodji's existing app (95% user adoption), customers will have the ability to log their waste disposal, by scanning the barcode on their meal's packaging in a gamification system. The system leverages behavioural science principles (rewards, social proof - competition and leaderboards) to make proper waste disposal the default choice for customers. This effectively bridges the behavioural gap between available infrastructure and proper disposal.

The impact goal is supported by ensuring high purity in recycling streams, and reducing contamination that leads to landfill. It preserves operational efficiency by using software-based incentives to drive impact. By making proper disposal the default choice for customers, Foodji strengthens its value proposition.

Metrics focus on scans per user per month to track habitual engagement, and contamination rates in onsite recycling bins. The recycling rate can be monitored by collaborating with client's waste management data to verify diversion from landfill.

The integration of the intervention with Foodji's existing app creates a highly scalable intervention which can easily be deployed across their locations. It is adaptable, allowing Foodji to tailor rewards or challenges to fit specific client cultures.

Intervention 3: Clamshell Packaging & Collection Bins

Finally, our third intervention proposes replacing Foodji's current dual-material HALOPACK with a 100% paper-based clamshell supported by dedicated Foodji-branded collection bins placed next to vending machines. By simplifying packaging into a single recyclable material and creating a closed-loop collection point, the system removes one of the biggest barriers to correct disposal material separation, while making recycling the easiest, most visible action for users.

This directly supports Foodji's packaging-waste reduction goal by increasing recycling purity, reducing contamination that sends fibre materials to landfill, and eliminating plastic film waste entirely. This reduces the friction for users to dispose of their packaging correctly, and is anchored in behavioural principles such as convenience, visual cueing, and social reinforcement to increase participation.

The effectiveness of the intervention can be measured through recycling capture rates, the volume of clamshells collected, and the reduction in mixed-waste contamination, while qualitative indicators include user ease-of-use feedback and client workplace satisfaction with clearer waste streams. As it relies on existing supplier capabilities and fits seamlessly into Foodji's current restocking routes, the intervention is highly scalable and can be deployed rapidly across workplace locations. It remains adaptable to regional recycling capabilities and can evolve to include compostable variants or broader material recovery streams as client needs and regulatory environments shift.

Rationale

	Intended Consequences	Unintended Consequences
1	**Short-Term:** Immediate reduction in onsite bin overflow and visual evidence of Foodji's sustainability commitment. **Long-Term:** Reduction in Foodji's packaging waste and increased customer satisfaction.	**Short-Term:** Increased fuel consumption in delivery due to significantly higher weight. **Long-Term:** Potential for 'jar hoarding' by customers, which could disrupt inventory levels. Mistakes in cleaning could result in health and safety issues.
2	**Short-Term:** Increase in app engagement, and cleaner recycling streams. **Long-Term:** Long-term behavioural change in users that extends beyond their interaction with the Foodji machine.	**Short-Term:** Potential for users to scan items without actually disposing of them. **Long-Term:** Users may stop participating once the novelty wears off, requiring constant iteration to keep the system effective.
3	**Short-Term:** Visible sustainability improvement for client workplaces, improving perception of Foodji's values. **Long-Term:** Stable, predictable packaging lifecycle using one material type leading to an easier procurement and operational efficiency.	**Short-Term:** Behaviour rebound effect, where Users may still place non-Foodji waste into Foodji-only bins, contaminating the stream **Long-Term:** Dependency on workplace compliance, i.e., if client facilities stop supporting bin placement, the loop breaks.

Evaluation

	Desirability	Feasibility	Viability	Sustainability
1	**High:** Customers perceive glass as higher quality and more eco-friendly. Potential to increase brand loyalty.	**Low:** High upfront cost for cleaning and logistics of fragile goods; requires strict health and safety protocols.	**Medium:** Increases operational costs, financial viability depends on achieving return rates.	**Low:** High maintenance effort due to the constant need for professional cleaning, breakage replacement, and complex reverse logistics.
2	**High:** Taps into social proof and competition, appeals to tech-savvy, users.	**Medium:** Necessary digital infrastructure and adoption already exists.	**Medium:** Low upfront costs but high ongoing reward expenses; ROI depends on user engagement.	**High:** effective for engaged users but limited in reach; risk of declining engagement after novelty fades.
3	**High:** Easiest for users; simple "put it in the bin" behaviour.	**Medium:** Requires supplier shift and bin rollout, but no major system changes.	**Medium:** Long-term depends on client cooperation and recycling partner reliability.	**Medium:** Removes plastic film & improves recyclability but remains single-use

Overview

After the evaluation of all intervention proposals, gamifying disposal presents as the most desirable, based on the measures outlined. Where glass jars elicit high operational costs and logistics, the new gamification system seamlessly integrates into the existing app, at a minimal cost to Foodji. The final intervention balances these, by providing a feasible way to reduce the waste of existing packaging, while encouraging Foodji to take responsibility of their material waste and strengthen their commitment to sustainability through a closed-loop collection system.